

Linking to or quoting other blogs is sometimes a good idea. If you find something on someone else's blog that you find interesting, and choose to write about it yourself, it takes just a modicum of humility to quote the other person and attribute the idea to him or her. It really shouldn't matter to you "who got there first": it will not if honesty is among your priorities. What is a bad idea is to quote another blog entirely. No-one needs that—a link with some commentary will do. Ditto for news items you're bringing to the attention of your readers.

Again, it's sometimes a good thing to quote a little bit of the other item, link to the page it has been lifted from, and then talk about the part you quoted and why it is interesting (to you and/or your readers). You'll see this often on many well-made blogs.

View some popular bloggers' blogs to see how they link to other pages or blogs, and how they quote their sources. You should get the general idea.

3.5 Articulateness

We cannot teach you how to be, but you need to be articulate if your blog is to be a success. This has several distinct aspects to it: don't use overly long sentences to sound wise. Don't write as you would speak, unless it's a very personal blog about, say, your dreams (which kind we're not really talking about here). Too much slang is a definite no-no. Clarity, precision, and conciseness are important. And so on.

While we're telling you not to sound wise, we're also telling you that writing with some authority is always a good thing. People don't want to be left wondering. Here's an example: instead of saying "there's some confusion about this, and I'm not sure what's going on," dig a little deeper and try and clear that confusion. If you're not able to, be absolutely clear about it: "This is something I don't have a clear answer to—do let me know if you